

POSTGRADUATE  
STUDENTS'  
HANDBOOK

2016

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## **1.1 INTRODUCTION**

Mount Kenya University offers diverse postgraduate academic programmes. The training modes are designed to equip postgraduate students with competencies, skills and attitudes necessary for a successful career development. The University School of Postgraduate Studies (SPGS) co-ordinates all matters related to postgraduate programmes and training.

## **1.2 CURRENT POSTGRADUATE PROGRAMMES**

Mount Kenya University has the following postgraduate programmes.

1. Masters
2. Ph.D.

## **2.0 REGULATIONS FOR POSTGRADUATE DEGREES**

### **2.1 MASTERS PROGRAMME**

The Masters degree programme has two (2) patterns of study:

- a) Masters degree by coursework, examination and thesis
  - Under this pattern, the candidates shall be required to do coursework, take examinations, conduct research, and submit a thesis for examination.
- b) Masters degree by coursework, examination and project
  - Under this pattern, the candidates shall take prescribed courses and examinations and a project.

#### **2.1.1 Admission Requirements**

The following shall be eligible for admission into a Masters Degree programme.

- a) A holder of a Bachelors Degree with Upper Second Class Honours and above of Mount Kenya University, or any other institution recognized by Mount Kenya University Senate.
- b) A holder of a Bachelors Degree with Lower Second Class Honours of Mount Kenya University, or any other institution recognized by Mount Kenya University Senate with two years and above relevant post-qualification experience.

- c) A non-holder of a Bachelors Degree can be admitted to a Masters programme as an exceptional case, provided such a candidate has published research, academic or/and creative work which qualifies the candidate to undertake postgraduate work.
- d) In addition to producing evidence of eligibility for registration, a candidate for the Masters Degree may be required to appear for an interview in the Department and/or School concerned to determine their suitability.
- e) Subject to the approval by the Senate, Schools may formulate regulations requiring applicants to have attained such academic or equivalent qualifications as may be consistent with the goals of their Masters programmes.

### **2.1.2 Transfer of Units**

- a) Course units may be considered for transfer to a Masters Degree programme provided they have been obtained from a recognized institution by Mount Kenya University Senate
- b) No more than fifty per cent (49%) of the total required course units will be accepted from other institutions.
- c) All units transferred should be of grade B and above and should be indicated in the transcript.
- d) The relevant department shall guide the School of Postgraduate Studies on transferable courses through their School and Institute

### **2.1.3 Processing of Applications**

- a) Applications shall be submitted to the Registrar, Admissions on the prescribed forms available at Mount Kenya University website [www.mku.ac.ke](http://www.mku.ac.ke)
- b) The Registrar, Admissions shall forward the filled forms to the relevant Departments, Schools or Institutes for evaluation.
- c) All applications shall be processed in the first instance by the relevant Departmental Postgraduate Studies Committee (DPSC) before being submitted to the relevant School Postgraduate Studies Committee (SPSC).

- d) Before recommending a candidate for admission, the SPSC concerned shall satisfy itself that:
  - (i) The proposed field of study is academically sound and can profitably be pursued under the supervision of Mount Kenya University Academic Staff
  - (ii) The candidate has adequate opportunities for consulting with supervisors at least once a month
  - (iii) The candidate can obtain access to materials relevant to the field of study or research work
  - (iv) The candidate has adequate facilities for practical fieldwork where this is applicable.
- e) The School shall then forward all such applications with appropriate comments to the Registrar, Admissions.

#### **2.1.4 Course Requirement and Duration of Study**

- a) The Masters Degree programme in all Schools shall extend over a period of at least eighteen (18) months and for a maximum of three (3) years and four (4) years from the date of registration for full time students and part-time students respectively.
- b) At the expiry of the study period any student who has not completed the programme will automatically cease to be a *bona fide* student of Mount Kenya University.

#### **2.1.5 Examination of Coursework**

Students taking coursework, examination and project or course work, examination and thesis shall be examined in all the units for which they have registered at the end of the semester in which they are taught.

- a) A written examination carries 60% and course work 40% of the total marks unless specified otherwise by the concerned Department and School.
- b) The pass mark in all Schools for each unit shall be 50%.
- c) Each unit is marked out of 100%. The marks are translated into literal grades as follows:
 

|   |   |                 |
|---|---|-----------------|
| A | – | 70% and above   |
| B | – | 60%-69%         |
| C | – | 50%-59%         |
| D | – | Below 50 (Fail) |

- d) At the end of each semester students shall be given results slips showing literal grades
- e) Any student who fails less than one third (1/3) of the units shall be required to take supplementary examinations for the failed units.
- f) A student who fails in more than one third (1/3) of the units in any academic year shall be discontinued.
- g) Students taking the first year examinations shall be required to pass in all the units including Supplementary examinations in order to proceed to the second academic year.
- h) Examination results shall be processed through the School Board of Examiners and will be approved by University Examination Board.
- i) Examination results for thesis will be processed and presented to Senate by the School of Postgraduate Studies.

#### **2.1.6 Extension of Registration Period**

- a) In exceptional circumstances you may request an extension of your period of registration as a student. The request should be made on university prescribed form (MKU/PG/F004) to the Registrar, Registration through the relevant Department (DPSC) and School (SPSC) two months before expiry. The reasons for extension and a schedule of activities to be carried out must be specified.
- b) Students who exceed the study period specified in the letter of admission shall be required to pay fees for the extra study period.

#### **2.1.7 Deferment/Suspension of Studies**

- a) A student may be allowed for good academic and personal reasons to suspend his/her studies for a period not exceeding one academic year.
- b) Requests for deferment should be addressed to the Dean, School of Postgraduate Studies stating reasonable grounds and the period of deferment.
- c) The Board of Postgraduate Studies shall consider the request and give recommendations to the Admissions Committee.

### **2.1.8 Re-admission**

A student who is unable to resume studies within one academic year may be re-admitted on recommendation from the concerned Department and the School, if the course duration has not expired.

If the course duration has expired, the student may be required to apply for fresh admission.

### **2.1.9 Conduct of Study and Supervision**

- a) Candidates registered in accordance with these regulations shall be required to pursue their programmes of study under the guidance of supervisors approved by the University Senate on the recommendations of the Department and School Board concerned through the Board of Postgraduate Studies.
- b) There shall normally be at least two (2) supervisors with relevant expertise and experience appointed for each candidate. One of the supervisors shall be appointed as the student's main supervisor.
- c) A candidate shall be required to meet the supervisors for consultation at least once every month. A supervision form must be filled by the Main supervisor (MKU/PG/F026).
- d) Supervisors shall submit progress reports on the candidate to the School of Postgraduate Studies through the Head of the Department and Dean of School on a prescribed form (MKU/PG/F006) once every three (3) months.
- e) Where the progress of the candidate is unsatisfactory, the candidate shall be warned in writing by the Dean of School through the Head of Department concerned. If the candidate shows no improvement after the warning within three (3) months, the Dean of School shall recommend to Senate through the Board of Postgraduate Studies for the candidate's deregistration.
- f) Where in the judgment of the Board of Postgraduate Studies, a candidate is not receiving proper supervision from the supervisor(s), the Board shall make recommendation to Senate on change of the supervisor(s).



## **2.2 DOCTOR OF PHILOSOPHY (PH.D)**

### **2.2.1 Doctor of Philosophy Degree Options**

There shall be two (2) study patterns:

- a) Doctor of Philosophy degree by coursework, examination, research and thesis
  - Under this option, the candidates shall be required to do coursework, take examinations, conduct research, and submit a thesis for examination.
- b) Doctor of Philosophy degree by research and thesis.
  - Under this option, the candidates shall conduct research, and submit a thesis for examination.

### **2.2.2 Admission Requirements and Procedures**

To be eligible for registration for a PhD degree programme:

- a) A candidate must have Masters Degree of Mount Kenya University or a Masters degree/other qualification from another university recognized by the Senate of Mount Kenya University.
- b) A candidate who holds a Bachelors Degree of Mount Kenya University or any other university recognized by senate of Mount Kenya University and has at least three years postgraduate research experience in the subject area and can produce proven evidence in the form of papers, reports, manuscripts, portfolios or other published works.
- c) In addition to producing evidence of eligibility for admission, candidates for the Doctor of Philosophy degree may be required interviewed by the school and/or department concerned.
- d) Senate shall have overall authority to admit or decline to admit a candidate for the degree.
- e) Subject to approval by the Senate, Schools may formulate regulations requiring applicants to have attained such academic or equivalent qualifications as may be consistent with the goals of their doctorate programmes.

### **2.2.3 Submission and Processing of Applications for Doctor of Philosophy by Coursework, Examination and Thesis**

#### ***PhD by Coursework***

- a) Applications shall be submitted to the Registrar, Admission on the prescribed forms available at the Mount Kenya University website [www.mku.ac.ke](http://www.mku.ac.ke)
- b) On application, admission office shall in the first instance forward all such applications to the relevant Departmental Postgraduate Studies Committee (DPSC) for evaluation
- c) The relevant department shall then forward all such applications with appropriate comments to their respective School Postgraduate Studies Committee (SPSC)
- d) Before recommending a candidate for admission, the SPSC concerned shall satisfy itself:
  - That proposed field of study is academically sound and can profitably be pursued under the supervision of Mount Kenya University Academic Staff
  - The candidate has adequate opportunities for consulting with supervisors at least once a month
  - The candidate can obtain access to materials relevant to the field of study or research work
  - The candidate has adequate facilities for practical fieldwork where this is applicable.
- e) The School shall then forward all such applications with appropriate comments to the Board of Postgraduate Studies.
- f) If satisfied with the applicant's eligibility, the Board of Postgraduate Studies shall make recommendations to Senate that the applicant be admitted and also advise the Registrar, Admissions to issue an admission letter.
- g) In case of rejection, the Registrar, Academic Affairs shall inform the applicant of the grounds for rejection.
- h) Senate shall have overall authority to admit or decline to admit a candidate for the degree

### ***PhD by Thesis Only***

- a) Once the provisional letter has been issued, the student shall in the first instance submit a synopsis (a summarised research concept) for consideration by the Department and School concerned.
- b) On receipt of the synopsis, the Dean, School of Postgraduate Studies shall forward the synopsis to the relevant Department and in consultation with the School Postgraduate Committee, shall recommend two supervisors.
- c) The relevant Dean of School shall then forward the names of the recommended supervisors to the Board of Postgraduate Studies.
- d) Once the supervisors are approved by Senate, the student with the assistance of the supervisors will develop a full proposal based on the guidelines for research proposal for PhD Degree.

### **2.2.4 Conduct of Study and Supervision**

- a) Each candidate shall be required to attend and participate in seminars at the relevant department and School/Institute.
- b) A candidate shall be required to pursue the programme of study under the supervision of an academic staff appointed in that capacity by the University Senate on the recommendation of the Department and School/Institute through the Board of Postgraduate Studies.
- c) There will be at least two (2) supervisors appointed for each candidate. Both supervisors must be PhD holders and members of the academic staff in the relevant field of study of the department offering the degree programme.
- d) A candidate shall be required to meet the supervisors for a tutorial session at least once every month. A supervision form (MKU/PG/F026) must be filled by all appointed supervisors together with the student.
- e) The supervisor shall be required to submit individually or jointly progress reports on the candidate to the Dean, School of Postgraduate Studies through the Head of Department and Dean of School/Institute once every three (3) months.

- f) Where the performance of the candidate is unsatisfactory, the candidate shall be given a written warning by the Dean, School of Postgraduate Studies through the Dean of School and Head of Department.
- g) A recommendation for de-registration shall be made to the University Examination Board by the Dean, School of Postgraduate Studies after receipt of two (2) consecutive unsatisfactory reports following the warning.

### **2.2.5 Examinations**

- a) Examinations for the PhD Degree shall be conducted under the authority of the University Examination Board as specified under various rules and regulations.
- b) Examinations shall consist of:
  - Continuous assessment based on assignments, laboratory practicals and such other tests as the regulations of the department may prescribe.
  - The final examinations
- c) Marks obtained in examinations shall be converted into letter grades as follows:
 

|   |   |                 |
|---|---|-----------------|
| A | – | 70% and above   |
| B | – | 60%-69%         |
| C | – | 50%-59%         |
| D | – | Below 50 (Fail) |
- d) Examination results for thesis will be processed and presented by the School of Postgraduate Studies to the University Examination Board.

### **2.2.6 Re-sit examinations**

A candidate who fails in twenty five per cent (25%) or less of the total courses taken in an academic year shall be required to re-sit examination once only.

Candidates shall be awarded grade “C” (50%) in all courses passed in re-sit examination.

### **3.0 PROCESSING POSTGRADUATE RESEARCH PROPOSALS**

- a) A thesis research proposal should not exceed forty (40) pages for Masters and fifty (50) pages for PhD (excluding the preliminary pages and the Appendices).
- b) A thesis research proposal (Masters and PhD) is ready once it has been successfully examined and corrected at the Department and at the concerned School levels and further considered by the School of Postgraduate Studies and approved by Senate.
- c) The student submits the proposal for registration through the supervisor(s), School Postgraduate Coordinator, and the Dean of School to the School of Postgraduate Studies together with a certificate of corrections signed by the supervisor(s), School Postgraduate Coordinator and the Dean of School.
- d) The proposal shall be received at the School of Postgraduate Studies and vetted to confirm that the candidate has complied with all the requirements.
- e) If the proposal meets all the requirements, the Certificate of Corrections (MKU/PG/F011) should be signed by the Supervisors, Postgraduate Coordinators, Dean of the relevant School and the Dean School of Postgraduate Studies.
- f) The candidate shall be cleared by the University Ethical Review Committee (ERC).
- g) After clearance by the ERC, the School of Postgraduate Studies shall issue the candidate with an introductory letter to facilitate application for clearance by NACOSTI to collect data for the study.

### **4.0 THESIS SUPERVISION AND PROGRESS REPORTS**

#### **4.1 APPOINTMENT OF SUPERVISORS**

- a) A candidate shall be required to pursue the thesis under instruction or supervision of a minimum of two qualified academic staff.

- b) Before a supervisor is appointed by the Human Resource Director, the Department, School concerned and the School of Postgraduate Studies must satisfy itself that the supervisor is competent in the subject area or field of research in which the candidate proposes to study.
- c) Each candidate shall be assigned a minimum of two supervisors.
- d) Normally one of the supervisors shall be appointed from among the academic staff of the Department concerned.
- e) For PhD, the supervisors must be PhD holders in the students' area of specialization and where there is lack of capacity, the second one can be within a closely related field.
- f) As per the recommendations of University Senate, the Human Resource Director shall appoint one of the supervisors as the candidate's main supervisor.
- g) A supervisor may be appointed from outside the University.
- h) The University Senate will withdraw the services of a supervisor upon recommendation by the Department and School through the School of Postgraduate Studies who in their opinion is not likely to assist the candidate finish his/her studies within the stipulated time.

#### **4.2 RESPONSIBILITIES OF SUPERVISORS**

It shall be the duty of the supervisor to direct and supervise the work of the student. In particular the supervisor shall:

- a) Maintain regular and effective contact with the student i.e. at least once per month and submit a report using the University prescribed form (**FORM - MKU/PG/F026**)
- b) Respond to any written materials from the student within the shortest time possible.
- c) Guide students to relevant literature and other sources of information.
- d) Link students to researchers working in related fields.
- e) Discuss and critically evaluate the student's findings and ideas.
- f) Advise students on the form and structure of thesis.
- g) Train students in the conventions of scholarly presentations.

- h) Enhance the quality of the student's work.
- i) Ensure that the student presents the research findings at the relevant seminars.
- j) Encourage and guide the student in publishing academic papers (at least one for Masters and two for PhD) from the research work.
- k) Submit individually or jointly academic progress reports on the student using the university prescribed form (**FORM - MKU/PG/F007**).
- l) Certify at the end of each semester that the candidate has received adequate supervision.

### **4.3 RESPONSIBILITIES OF STUDENTS**

Candidates shall be responsible for the following:

- a) Maintaining regular consultation with their supervisors, i.e. at least once per month and ensuring that the supervision form (**FORM - MKU/PG/F026**) is filled and a copy submitted to the School of Postgraduate Studies for filing.
- b) Submitting progress reports at the end of every semester through their supervisors, DPSC and SPSC to the Board of Postgraduate Studies. All progress reports must have a copy of the work plan attached and should show the number of meetings held with the supervisor, dates of the meetings, work so far accomplished, work yet to be done and the time required to complete. (**FORM - MKU/PG/F007**).
- c) Participating in seminars organized by the Departments, Schools and School of Postgraduate Studies (**FORM -MKU/PG/F014**).
- d) Securing, organizing and presenting content professionally and accurately.
- e) Adhering to the University Research Policies and Regulations including Research Ethics, Anti-Plagiarism, Copyrights and Intellectual property rights.
- f) Adhering to correct format of presenting quotations, footnotes, references, tables, and other illustrative materials.
- g) Show evidence of publishing at least one (for Masters Students)/two (for PhD students) academic papers before the graduation.

- h) Presenting intention to submit the proposal/thesis to the relevant Department as stipulated in the University Regulations
- i) Defending all aspects of the thesis during oral examination.
- j) Making corrections recommended by the Board of Examiners.
- k) Ensuring that the required number of copies of the thesis and the original are duly signed and the Certificate of Corrections are submitted to the Board of Postgraduate Studies
- l) Satisfy University administrative requirements as stipulated in the University Statutes.

#### **4.4 RESPONSIBILITIES OF THE RELEVANT SCHOOL**

- a) Propose supervisors through the SPC for approval and appointment
- b) Recommend reviewers through the SPC for approval and appointment
- c) Organize Departmental and School seminar presentations
- d) Constitute proposal review panels and submit the proposals to the School of Postgraduate Studies
- e) Provide necessary support for Research work.
- f) Propose thesis Examiners through the SPC for approval and appointment

#### **4.5 RESPONSIBILITIES OF THE SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

- a) Recommend the Supervisors proposed by the Schools and forward to Senate for approval.
- b) Approve reviewers recommended by the Schools
- c) Recommend the Boards of Examiners proposed by the Schools and forward to Senate.
- d) Oversee and advise on the best practices in Research supervision
- e) Timely issuance of relevant fieldwork documents
- f) Ensure timely examination of theses
- g) Provide secretariat during proposal and seminar presentations



- h) Process and submit to the Schools the list of students who have successfully completed their research work
- i) Regular monitoring of students' progress reports
- j) Approve justified changes of supervisors following recommendations of the Departments and Schools.

## **5.0 SEMINARS**

- a) Masters students shall be required to give two (2) seminars in addition to the defence of a research proposal in the relevant department before submission of a thesis for examination. These will be:
  - i) A Research-in-progress presentation at the School level.
  - ii) A dissemination of research findings at the School of Postgraduate level.
- b) A PhD candidate shall be required to give three (3) seminars in addition to the defence of a research proposal in the relevant department before submission of a thesis for examination.
  - i) A Research-in-progress presentation at the School level
  - ii) A presentation of a publication/journal article at School level.
  - iii) A dissemination of research findings at the School of Postgraduate Studies level.

## **6.0 ACADEMIC TRANSCRIPTS**

- a) A transcript will be issued free of charge by the Registrar, Academic Affairs at the end of the degree programme.
- b) Additional transcripts shall be issued at a fee.
- c) A transcript may be issued to a student before completion of the programme on request at a fee.

## **7.0 PRESENTATION OF RESEARCH PROPOSAL/ THESIS**

### **7.1 RESEARCH PROPOSAL/ THESIS WRITING**

Research Proposal/Thesis writing should conform to the Mount Kenya University format as stated below:

- a) Consistency in the language used.

- b) APA referencing style may be used across the text as a University writing style.
- c) A soft copy of the proposal/thesis must be checked using the Turn-it-in Anti-plagiarism software available in the University Library before submission (a maximum of 15% similarity Index excluding references and 20% including references will be acceptable).

### **Typing of Proposal/Thesis**

A proposal/thesis must be typed and printed on an A4 size, good quality paper. Any deviation from this standard paper size must be approved by the Board of Postgraduate Studies. The typeface will be Times New Roman, font size 12 and consistency must be maintained. Double or one-and-a-half line-spacing shall be used for the main text (except for the abstract, indented quotations or footnotes where single-line-spacing shall be used).

### **Printing**

Printing should be on one side of the paper only.

### **Margins**

The top and bottom margins should be 2.5cm deep. The right hand margin should be 2cm while the left hand margin should be 3cm (for proposals) and 4cm (for thesis ready for hard-binding).

### **Pagination**

Pages shall be numbered consecutively in Arabic numerals, starting with the first page of text and the number shall appear in the centre of the lower margin of the page. Preliminary pages such as table of contents, list of tables and figures that precede the first page of text shall be numbered using small Roman numerals.

### **Chapters and Major sections**

Chapters and major sections (for example, Introduction, Literature Review, Materials and Methods, Research Methodology, etc.) should begin on a new page. All sub-sections may begin immediately after except that sub-section heading should not be placed at the bottom of a page unless it is followed by two lines of text.

Headings must be internally consistent. Partly filled pages of text are not permitted except at the end of a chapter where there is no sufficient room to place four or five lines of text either above or below.

**Title Page (Text should be in capital letters and centred)**

a) The first page bears the research title with the full names of the candidate below it.

b) The legend shall appear below the name as follows:

**A RESEARCH PROPOSAL/THESIS SUBMITTED IN PARTIAL  
FULFILMENT OF THE REQUIREMENT FOR THE AWARD OF  
(insert the name of the degree) DEGREE IN (insert) OF  
MOUNT KENYA UNIVERSITY**

**(Note that ‘Mount Kenya University’ shall be on a separate line with no  
space before it.)**

The date of submission shall appear below in the form of month and year.

**Declaration and Approval page**

The second page must contain:

a) A signed declaration by the candidate with the following statement:

**This thesis is my original work and has not been presented for a  
degree in any other University or for any other award.**

b) A signed approval by the University Supervisor and all other Supervisors with the following statement:

**I/We confirm that the work reported in this thesis was carried out by  
the candidate under my/our supervision**

The names of the supervisors shall be accompanied by their affiliation (the name of the University/Organisation where he/she is based).

**Dedication page**

A dedication statement not exceeding 25 words may follow the declaration (only in the thesis).

**Acknowledgment page**

Acknowledgment not exceeding 150 words should follow the dedication page.

**Abstract Page**

An abstract of the research proposal/thesis not exceeding five hundred words should be placed just before chapter one. It should be a one paragraph continuous prose, single spaced and on one page.

**Table of Contents**

A computer auto-generated table of contents should follow the acknowledgment page, beginning on a new page. The table of contents should assist the reader to know quickly and clearly how the research proposal/thesis is organized. There must be consistency in the use of headings and sub-headings in both the table of contents and the text.

**List of Tables**

A computer auto-generated list of tables should follow the table of contents, beginning on a separate page.

**List of Figures**

A computer auto-generated list of figures should be on a separate page immediately after the list of tables.

**List of abbreviations and acronyms**

A list of abbreviations and acronyms that have been used in the text should follow the list figures, before the abstract page, with the full form of the abbreviations and acronyms.

**Tables, Figures and Plates**

- a) Tables, figures and plates may be included within the text or appear on separate pages. If on separate pages, they should be placed near the text which refers to them.
- b) Each table, figure and plate shall have a full caption. Tables, figures and plates should be numbered in sequence and should be cited by a number in the text. A table, figure and plate must fit within the margins previously mentioned.
- c) Figure numbers and titles should appear below the figure.

- d) Table numbers and titles should appear above the table.
- e) Whenever possible, photographs should be printed directly on A4 photographic paper. However, in special cases, photographs may be mounted on 100% bond paper by use of double adhesive mounting paper. A lamination process may also be used.

## **References**

The APA referencing style should be used as stated at the beginning of this section. In-text citations, tables, figures, paragraphs, references and bibliographies must be consistent with the writing style.

## **Appendices**

This section shall include such documents as:

- a) Research instruments
- b) Letters of introduction/authorization/ethical clearance
- c) Research permit
- d) Proposed research budget
- e) Projected work plan for carrying out research
- f) Long tables, alien data, paragraphs, maps, and place locations, etc.

## **Hard-binding**

Two copies of the hard-bound thesis shall be submitted in maroon colour (for PhD) and black colour (for Masters) together with a soft copy in a compact disk (CD) which will include the whole thesis and the abstract saved separately.

### **7.1.1 Research Proposal /Thesis Template**

Below is a sample of the research proposal /thesis template.

## SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES

### PROPOSAL/THESIS TEMPLATE

#### **PREAMBLE**

A research proposal/thesis should as much as possible contain all the sections outlined here below. This format provides a general framework to serve as a guide to students doing research work. Schools and Departments can make any necessary adjustment to meet/suit their specific requirements.

#### **1.0 COVER PAGE (All text should be centered and in capital letters)**

- 1. Research title/topic of study.** This is normally written about three centimeters from the top of the page.
- 2. The name of the author of the proposal/project/thesis**
- 3. The following MKU legend** will be placed just about twelve centimeters from the bottom of the page “A research proposal/thesis submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirement for the award of .... Degree in ... of Mount Kenya University.”
- 4. The month and year** when the document is submitted will appear about five centimeters from the bottom of the cover page.

## **2.0. THE PROPOSAL/PROJECT/THESIS CONTENTS AT A GLANCE**

- i) Preliminaries** – normally numbered using the Roman numerals: i, ii, iii, iv, etc. and placed at the bottom of the page.
- ii) Chapter One: Introduction**
- iii) Chapter Two: Literature Review**
- iv) Chapter Three: Research Methodology/Materials and Methods**
- v) Chapter Four: Research Findings/Results and Discussions**
- vi) Chapter Five: Summary, Conclusions and Recommendations**
- vii) References**
- viii) Appendices**

## **3.0. PROPOSAL/THESIS CONTENTS IN SKETCH**

### **3.1 Preliminary Pages**

- 1. The title/cover page-** as detailed above. The research title should be stated in as few words as possible (not more than nineteen) and without ambiguity whatsoever.
- 2. Declaration and approval page** - both the researcher and the supervisor's signatures should be appended on this page; with the relevant captions preceding the signatures. The researcher's Registration Number should appear below the name. Where there are more than one supervisor, the name of the **Main** supervisor appears first.
- 3. Dedication (thesis)** – compliments in recognition of particular individuals who occupy a special place in the life of the researcher.
- 4. Acknowledgements** – appreciating those people who in a way or the other, have contributed to the realization of the research proposal or thesis.

5. **Abstract** – written in one single-spaced paragraph on one page; and not more than five hundred (500) words. It forms an executive summary of the entire research proposal/thesis at a glance.
6. **Table of contents** – this is a detailed outline of what is contained in the research proposal/thesis (Should incorporate only two levels).
7. **List of tables.** List of all the tables used in the project/thesis report or proposal
8. **List of figures/plates/pictures etc.** or whichever is applicable as may have been used in the research proposal/thesis.
9. **List of abbreviations and acronyms** – introduces to the reader words that have been used in their short forms to stand for a more expansive form of use.

### **3.2 CHAPTER ONE INTRODUCTION**

1. Background to the study
2. Statement of the problem
3. Purpose of the study
4. Objectives of the study
5. Research questions or hypotheses
6. Significance/Rationale/Justification of the study
7. Scope of the study
8. Study limitations
9. Delimitations
10. Assumptions of the study
11. Operational definition of key terms- explaining how certain terms have been used in a special way in the context of the research proposal/thesis only.



### **3.3 CHAPTER TWO LITERATURE REVIEW**

1. Introduction
2. Empirical literature (literature should clearly identify the research gap)
3. Theoretical literature/Theoretical framework
4. Conceptual framework
5. Recap of literature review

#### **Option 1**

### **3.4 CHAPTER THREE- RESEARCH METHODOLOGY (For studies conducted in the field)**

1. Introduction
2. Research methodology
3. Research design (Discuss the Variables)
4. Location of the study
5. Target population
6. Sampling procedures and techniques
7. Sample population
8. Construction of research instruments
9. Testing for validity and reliability/trustworthiness
10. Data collection methods and procedures
11. Proposed data analysis techniques and procedures
12. Ethical considerations

#### **Option 2**

### **3.4 CHAPTER THREE- MATERIALS AND METHODS (For studies conducted in the laboratory/Experiments)**

1. Introduction
2. Study design

3. Study area/site
4. Study population/target organism
5. Sample size determination
6. Sampling procedure
7. Inclusion and exclusion criteria
8. Experimental and laboratory techniques
9. Quality control
10. Data management
11. Data analysis and presentation
12. Ethical considerations

**NB: The content of the research proposal will normally end at chapter three and its contents are usually written in the future tense. The dedication page need not be included in the proposal. The references, research instruments and other essential appendices will however, come immediately after this chapter.**

### **End of research proposal**

## **3.5 CHAPTER FOUR: RESEARCH FINDINGS, ANALYSIS AND PRESENTATION**

1. Introduction
2. Research presentation, interpretation and discussions
3. Discussion of individual objective results. This is guided by the research objectives and research questions

## **3.6 CHAPTER FIVE: SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS**

1. Introduction

2. Summary of the result findings
3. Conclusions – should strictly be based on the research findings
4. Recommendations for practice to
  - i) The authorities for implementation
  - ii) Service users/ beneficiaries
  - iii) Other stakeholders
5. Recommendations for further research in this field of study

### **3.7 LIST OF REFERENCES**

To include only the resources the researcher has literary and physically interacted with. APA style of referencing is very strongly recommended. Only recent publications in the area of study are to be consulted.

### **3.8 APPENDICES**

To include such documents as:

- i) Questionnaires
- ii) Letters of introduction/authorization
- iii) Proposed research budget
- iv) Projected work plan for carrying out research
- v) Long tables; alien data; paragraphs; maps and place locations etc.

### **Note**

- 1. It is important that the Mount Kenya University Format is maintained.**
- 2. Approval should be sought should there be need to deviate from the above research proposal/ thesis writing specifications.**

### **8.0 SUBMISSION AND EXAMINATION OF THESIS**

- a) At least three (3) months before a thesis is submitted, a candidate shall with the consent of the supervisor(s) give notice in writing to the Dean,

School of Postgraduate Studies and through the Head of the concerned Department and the Dean of the concerned School indicating intention to submit the thesis.

- b) Upon receiving the notice to submit thesis, the Head of Department shall recommend the external examiner and one internal examiner to the Board of Postgraduate Studies through the Dean of School or Director of Institute.
- c) The University Senate, on the recommendation of the Board of Postgraduate Studies, shall appoint a Board of Examiners consisting of:
  - i) The Dean of the School – Chairperson
  - ii) Internal Examiner (Non-Supervisor)
  - iii) Internal Examiner (Supervisor)
  - iv) External Examiner
  - v) Two (2) School Representatives
  - vi) A Senate Representative
- d) Five loosely bound copies of the thesis shall be accompanied by a signed declaration by the candidate confirming that the thesis has not been previously submitted for a Degree in any other University and that the thesis is the original work of the candidate. The thesis shall bear the signature(s) of the supervisor(s) as an indication of approval to submit. **The copies of the thesis shall also be accompanied by a plagiarism report produced by the Turn-it-in software or a soft copy of the thesis.**
- e) Upon receiving the thesis, the School of Postgraduate Studies and the concerned School shall forward the same to the examiners within two (2) weeks from the date of submission of the thesis.
- f) The examiners (external and internal) shall be required to submit within fourteen (14) days independent written assessments of the thesis to the Dean, School of Postgraduate Studies indicating whether or not the:
  - i) thesis is adequate in form and content;
  - ii) thesis reflects an adequate understanding of the subject, and, in consequence;
  - iii) degree should be awarded.

- h) Once all the examiners' reports are received, the Dean, School of Postgraduate Studies, in consultation with the Dean of the relevant School, shall convene a meeting of the Board of Examiners at which the reports and other academic matters arising from the thesis shall be considered. The Board of Examiners shall subject the candidate to an oral examination to enable it to arrive at a satisfactory recommendation on the merit of the thesis. The passing of the candidate shall be based on the decision of the majority of the Board of Examiners.
- i) The Board will require the candidate to revise and resubmit the thesis for examination when corrections are major
- j) The recommendations of the Board of Examiners shall be communicated verbally to the candidate after the oral defence and in writing by the Dean, School of Postgraduate Studies within two (2) weeks after the defence.
- k) A signed certificate of corrections shall be issued by the supervisor(s) to the School of Postgraduate Studies through the Dean of relevant School.
- l) In the event that the title of the study changes immensely, then an application form for change of thesis title will be filled (**FORM MKU/PG/F025**).
- m) The results of the examination shall be approved by the University Examination Board.

## **9.0 EXAMINATION AND RESEARCH MALPRACTICES FOR POSTGRADUATE STUDENTS**

The following academic malpractices are considered serious and any student guilty of any of them shall be liable to discontinuation or expulsion from the University

- a) Copying or reading from another candidate's script or from any other unauthorised source.
- b) Bringing into the examination room any unauthorised materials relevant to the examination, e.g., books, notes, electronic devices with pre-set formulae, mobile phones, pre-written answers, etc.
- c) Assisting or covering up an examination malpractice.
- d) Seeking to delay or reschedule an examination on false pretence.

- e) Collecting research data without the required ethical clearance and/or authorisation
- f) Plagiarism.
- g) Giving of false research data or results and purporting them to be authentic.
- h) Any deviation from the research procedures as prescribed in the approved research project proposal without consent of the designated supervisors.
- i) Any other misconduct related to examination/research.



## SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES

*MKU/PG/F003: MASTER'S STUDENTS STUDY PLAN GUIDELINES***MODE I**

| PATTERN                                     | SEMESTERS                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                             | I                                                                                                                                                                                                    | II                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | III                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | IV                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Course work,<br>Examinations and<br>Project | i) course work<br>ii) examinations<br>iii) literature review<br>iv) group discussions<br>v) seminars<br>vi) supervisor<br>identification and<br>approval<br>vii) supervisor –<br>student interaction | i) course work<br>ii) examinations<br>iii) literature<br>review<br>iv) group<br>discussions<br>v) seminars<br>vi) research area<br>identification<br>vii) research<br>concept<br>writing<br>viii) supervisor –<br>student<br>interaction | i) Course work<br>ii) Literature<br>review<br>iii) Literature<br>review chapter<br>writing<br>iv) Group<br>discussion<br>v) Seminars<br>vi) Research<br>proposal<br>writing and<br>approval<br>vii) Materials and<br>method<br>chapter writing<br>viii) Research<br>materials &<br>equipment<br>acquisition<br>ix) Research fund<br>acquisition<br>x) Data collection<br>xi) Supervisor –<br>student<br>interaction | i) Literature review<br>ii) Data collection<br>iii) Enriching literature<br>review chapter<br>iv) Data analysis &<br>results writing<br>v) Project report<br>writing<br>vi) Progress report<br>submission<br>vii) Manuscript<br>preparation<br>viii) Supervisor – student<br>interaction<br>ix) Project report<br>assessment.<br>x) Certification |

## MODE II

|                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Course work,<br>Examination<br>and Thesis | i) course work<br>ii) examinations<br>iii) literature review<br>iv) group discussions<br>v) seminars<br>vi) supervisor identification and approval<br>vii) Research area identification<br>viii) Research concept paper writing<br>ix) supervisor – student interaction | i) course work<br>ii) examinations<br>iii) literature review<br>iv) group discussions<br>v) seminars<br>vi) Research proposal writing and approval<br>vii) Writing of materials and methods<br>viii) Research material and equipment acquisition<br>ix) Research fund acquisition | B. Literature review<br>C. Data collection<br>D. Enriching literature review chapter<br>E. Data analysis and results chapter writing<br>F. Seminars<br>G. Group discussions<br>H. Supervisor – student interaction<br>I. Progress report submission and assessment | i) Literature review<br>ii) Enriching literature review chapter<br>iii) Data analysis and results chapter writing<br>iv) Seminars<br>v) Group discussions<br>vi) Thesis writing<br>vii) Thesis submission<br>viii) Thesis submission<br>ix) Appointment of Board of Examiners<br>x) Thesis defence<br>xi) Certification |
|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|



**SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES*****MKU/PG/ F004: APPLICATION FORM FOR EXTENSION OF STUDY PERIOD******To be completed in triplicate and submitted to Registrar, Academic Affairs*****PART I: STUDENT PARTICULARS**

Name..... Reg. No: .....

Programme of Study: .....

Year of Study: ..... Trimester: .....

I request the Postgraduate Studies Committee to allow me to extend the study period by..... months because of the following reasons.

1. ....  
.....

2. ....  
.....

3. ....  
.....

Signature of student: ..... Date: .....

**PART II: FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY****COMMENTS BY SUPERVISORS AND HEAD OF DEPARTMENT**

Name of Main supervisor .....

Signature ..... Date .....

Name of Supervisor: .....

Signature ..... Date .....

Head of Department .....

Signature ..... Date .....

### COMMENTS BY THE DEAN OF SCHOOL

Recommended / Not recommended for extension. (*Delete appropriately*)

Remarks (if any)

.....  
.....

Name ..... Signature..... Date.....

### COMMENTS BY THE CHAIRMAN, POSTGRADUATE STUDIES COMMITTEE

Recommended / Not recommended for extension. (*Delete appropriately*)

Remarks (if any)

.....  
.....

Name: ..... Signature: ..... Date: .....

MKU/PG/ F005



**SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

***MKU/PG/ F005: APPLICATION FORM FOR ACADEMIC LEAVE***

***To be completed in triplicate and submitted to Registrar, Academic Affairs***

**PART I: STUDENT PARTICULARS**

Name: ..... Reg. No: .....

Programme of Study: .....

Year of Study: ..... Trimester: .....

I request the University to allow me to withdraw from the above study programme because of the following reasons:

1. ....
2. ....
3. ....
4. ....

**PART II: FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY**

**COMMENTS BY SUPERVISORS AND HEAD OF DEPARTMENT**

Name of Main supervisor.....

Signature..... Date.....

Name of Main supervisor.....

Signature..... Date.....

Head of Department.....

Signature..... Date.....

**COMMENTS BY THE DEAN OF SCHOOL**

Remarks (if any)

.....  
.....

Name: ..... Signature: ..... Date: .....

**DEAN, SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

Approved/Not approved

Remarks (if any)

.....  
.....

Name: ..... Signature: ..... Date: .....

**REGISTRAR ACADEMIC AFFAIRS**

Approved/Not approved

Remarks (if any)

.....  
.....

Name: ..... Signature: ..... Date: .....



**SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

***MKU/PG/ F006: APPLICATION FOR CHANGE OF REGISTRATION STATUS***  
***To be completed in triplicate and submitted to Registrar, Academic Affairs***

**PART I: STUDENT PARTICULARS**

Name: ..... Reg. No: .....  
Programme of Study: .....  
Year of Study: ..... Trimester: .....

I wish to apply for a change of registration status from ..... to  
..... because of the following reasons:

1. ....
2. ....
3. ....
4. ....

Student Signature: ..... Date: .....

**PART II: FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY**

**COMMENTS BY SUPERVISORS AND HEAD OF DEPARTMENT**

Name of Main supervisor.....  
Signature..... Date.....

Name of Main supervisor.....  
Signature..... Date.....

Head of Department.....  
Signature..... Date.....

### COMMENTS BY THE DEAN OF SCHOOL

Recommended /Not recommended for change of registration status. (*Delete appropriately*)

Remarks (if any)

.....  
.....

Name: ..... Signature: ..... Date: .....

### DEAN, SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES

Recommended /Not recommended for change of registration status. (*Delete appropriately*)

Remarks (if any)

.....  
.....

Name: ..... Signature: ..... Date: .....



**SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

***MKU/PG/F007: POSTGRADUATE STUDENT PROGRESS REPORT FORM***

**PART I: INSTRUCTIONS**

Postgraduate student progress reports must be submitted at the end of every trimester through the supervisors, Heads of relevant Department and Dean of relevant School to the Chairman, Postgraduate Studies Committee.

**PART II: STUDENT PARTICULARS**

Name of student .....  
Registration Number ..... Year of study: .....  
Academic Year: ..... Trimester: .....  
Department: ..... School: .....  
Programme: .....  
Duration Expected completion date: .....

**PART III: PROJECT / THESIS:**

Title of Project / Thesis  
.....  
.....  
.....  
.....

Research Objectives  
.....  
.....  
.....  
.....  
.....  
.....  
.....

.....  
 .....  
**PART IV: CONSULTATIVE MEETINGS WITH SUPERVISOR PER SEMESTER**

Consultative meetings were held as outlined below:

|      | <u>Meeting</u> | <u>Dates</u> |
|------|----------------|--------------|
| i)   | .....          | .....        |
| ii)  | .....          | .....        |
| iii) | .....          | .....        |

Objectives so far accomplished:

.....  
 .....  
 .....  
 .....

**PART V: WORK PLAN FOR NEXT TRIMESTER**

Work plan for ..... academic year .....  
 trimester is outlined below

| Activity | Duration | Remarks by supervisor |
|----------|----------|-----------------------|
|          |          |                       |
|          |          |                       |
|          |          |                       |
|          |          |                       |

General Remarks

.....  
 .....  
 .....

.....  
 Student Signature

.....  
 Date



## PART VI: FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY

Remarks by supervisor

.....  
.....

Name of Main supervisor.....

Signature..... Date.....

Name of Main supervisor.....

Signature..... Date.....

Recommendations by Head of Department to Dean of relevant School

.....  
.....

Name of Head of Department: .....

Signature: ..... Date: .....

Recommendations by Dean of relevant School to Chairman, Postgraduate Studies  
Committee

.....  
.....

Name of Dean of School: .....

Signature: ..... Date: .....

Recommendations by Dean SPGS to Senate

.....  
.....

Name of the Dean: .....

Signature: ..... Date: .....

**SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

***MKU/PG/F009: NOTICE OF INTENTION TO SUBMIT THESIS FOR EXAMINATION***

***To be completed in triplicate and submitted to Dean, School of Postgraduate Studies three months before the date of submission of thesis***

**PART I: STUDENT PARTICULARS**

Name ..... Reg. No. ....

Department ..... School .....

P.O Box .....

Email Address .....

Cell Phone No. ....

I intend to submit my PhD/ Master's thesis for examination on or before  
.....Day of .....20.....

**PART II: TITLE OF THESIS**

.....  
.....  
.....  
.....

**PART III: AREAS OF SPECIALIZATION**

.....  
.....  
.....  
.....

Student's signature ..... Date.....

## **PART IV: COMMENTS BY SUPERVISORS**

### **First Supervisor (Main)**

Name.....  
University.....  
Department.....  
Address.....  
Cell Phone Number.....  
E-mail address.....  
Comments.....  
.....

Signature ..... Date .....

### **Second Supervisor**

Name.....  
University.....  
Department.....  
Address.....  
Cell Phone Number.....  
  
Comments.....  
.....

Signature ..... Date .....

## **PART V: COMMENTS BY HEAD OF DEPARTMENT**

Recommended / Not recommended (Delete appropriately)

Remarks (if any)

.....  
.....

## **PART VI: PROPOSED MEMBERS OF BOARD OF EXAMINERS**

### **External Examiner**

Names.....  
University.....  
Department.....  
Address.....  
Cell Phone Number.....  
E-mail address.....

### **Internal Examiner (Non-Supervisor)**

Names.....  
University.....  
Department.....  
Address.....  
Cell Phone Number.....  
E-mail address.....

## **PART VI: PROPOSED SCHOOL BOARD MEMBERS**

### **1. School Board Member**

Names.....  
University.....  
Department.....  
Address.....  
Cell Phone Number.....  
E-mail address.....

### **2. School Board Member**

Names.....  
University.....  
Department.....  
Address.....  
Cell Phone Number.....  
E-mail address.....

**NB: The curriculum vitae of new external examiners should be attached.  
The books should NOT accompany the notice of intention to submit.**

**PART VII: COMMENTS BY CHAIRMAN, POSTGRADUATE STUDIES COMMITTEE**

Recommended / Not recommended (Delete appropriately)

Remarks (if any) .....  
.....

**PART VIII: PROPOSED SENATE REPRESENTATIVE**

**Senate Representative**

Names.....

University.....

Department.....

Address.....

Cell Phone Number.....

E-mail address.....



**SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

***MKU/PG/F010: THESIS BOARD OF EXAMINERS REPORT FORM***

***This form is to be completed, signed by all the examiners and returned to the chairman of the Postgraduate Studies Committee immediately after the meeting.***

**PART I: STUDENT PARTICULARS**

- (a) Name ..... Reg. No .....
- (b) School .....Department .....
- (c) Programme of study: .....
- (d) Area of specialization  
.....  
.....
- (e) Title of thesis  
.....  
.....  
.....

**PART II: COMMENTS BY BOARD OF EXAMINERS**

- i) Ability and level of verbal presentation & articulation  
.....  
.....  
.....
- ii) Clarity of the Research Title (**Not exceeding 21 words**)  
.....  
.....  
.....
- iii) Statement of the Research Problem, Study Objectives and Research questions  
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**FURTHER COMMENTS**

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### PART III: SCORING GUIDE

| <b>SCORING GUIDE – Tick (✓) as appropriate</b> |  |
|------------------------------------------------|--|
| 65 – 100 – Pass with Minor adjustments         |  |
| 50 – 64 – Pass with corrections                |  |
| 40 – 49 – Needs overhaul to resubmit (Defer)   |  |
| 01 – 39 – Fail – to repeat                     |  |

### PART III: RECOMMENDATIONS OF THE BOARD OF EXAMINERS (Tick appropriately)

- a) The thesis has minor corrections to be made. The degree can be awarded once these corrections have been attended to within three (3) months from the date of this oral examination. ☐
- b) The thesis has corrections that should be done within six (6) months from the date of this oral examination. The degree can be awarded once these corrections are done. ☐
- c) The thesis has major corrections and requires to be revised. The revision should be done within 12 months from the date of this oral examination with assistance from an additional supervisor who will be recommended by the Board of examiners to oversee the corrections. The thesis should be re-submitted, re-examined and re-defended. ☐
- d) The candidate's thesis does not meet the minimum threshold for the award of the degree and therefore FAILS due to the following reasons. ☐
- (i) .....  
.....
- (ii) .....  
.....
- (iii) .....  
.....



#### **PART IV: CORRECTIONS / REVISION SUPERVISORS**

The following supervisors will oversee the corrections / revision

| <b><u>Name of supervisor</u></b> | <b><u>Department</u></b> |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------|
| (i) Prof/Dr. /Mr. /Mrs. ....     | .....                    |
| (ii) Prof/Dr./Mr./Mrs.....       | .....                    |
| (iii) Prof/Dr. /Mr. /Mrs.....    | .....                    |

**PART V: MEMBERS OF THE EXAMINERS PANEL.**

| <i>Members' Names</i>                         | <i>Signature</i> |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------|
| 1. Chairman/ Sch. Dean Prof/Dr .....          | .....            |
| 2. External Examiner Prof/Dr .....            | .....            |
| 3. Internal Examiner Prof/Dr .....            | .....            |
| 4. Supervisor Prof/Dr .....                   | .....            |
| 5. 1 <sup>st</sup> Board Member Prof/Dr ..... | .....            |
| 6. 2 <sup>nd</sup> Board Member Prof/Dr ..... | .....            |
| 7. Senate Representative Prof/Dr .....        | .....            |
| 8. Panel's Secretary Dr/Mr/Ms. ....           | .....            |
| Examination date .....                        |                  |

MKU/PG/F011



**SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

**MKU/PG/F011: RESEARCH PROPOSAL CERTIFICATE OF CORRECTIONS**

***(NB: This Research Proposal Certificate of corrections should be submitted to the Dean, School of Postgraduate Studies for clearance before the Student proceeds to collect data)***

**PART I: CANDIDATE PARTICULARS**

Name of candidate Dr./Mr./Ms .....  
Registration No: .....  
Department of study: .....  
Cell phone No: .....  
School: .....  
Degree Title (MA, MED, PhD): .....  
Area of specialization: .....  
Title of Thesis: .....  
.....  
.....  
Date of Presentation:.....  
  
Signature of candidate: ..... Date: .....

**PART II: DECLARATION OF SUPERVISOR(S) OVERSEEING CORRECTION / REVISION**

I/We, the undersigned supervisor(s) overseeing corrections of the research proposal as advised by the candidate's evaluation panel do hereby declare that all the corrections have been effected satisfactorily as required.

Any other remarks .....  
.....  
.....  
.....

Names of Supervisors

Signature

Date

- |         |       |       |
|---------|-------|-------|
| 1. .... | ..... | ..... |
| 2. .... | ..... | ..... |
| 3. .... | ..... | ..... |

**PART III: CONFIRMATION BY THE CAMPUS/ SCHOOL POSTGRADUATE COORDINATOR**

I hereby do confirm that the supervisor(s) appointed to oversee the candidate effect the corrections on the research proposal have done so as per the instructions of the candidate's evaluation panel.

Any other remarks

.....  
.....  
.....

Name of Coordinator: .....

Signature ..... Date .....

Stamp .....

**PART IV: CONFIRMATION BY THE DEAN OF THE RELEVANT SCHOOL**

I hereby do confirm that the supervisor(s) appointed to oversee the candidate effect the corrections on the research proposal have done so as per the instructions of the candidate's evaluation panel.

Any other remarks

.....  
.....

Name of Dean .....

Signature ..... Date .....

School Stamp .....

**PART V: CLEARANCE BY THE UNIVERSITY ETHICAL REVIEW COMMITTEE**

The candidate will be issued with a Certificate of Ethical Clearance by the Directorate of Research and Development.

**PART VI: COMMENTS BY THE DEAN SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

The candidate is granted/not granted permission to proceed to the field to collect data (delete where applicable)

**NB:** One (1) copy of the corrected/revised research proposal should accompany this certificate of corrections

Name of Dean .....  
(School of Postgraduate Studies)

Signature ..... Date .....

School Stamp .....

MKU/PG/F012



**SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

**MKU/PG/F012: CERTIFICATE OF CORRECTIONS/ REVISION OF THESIS**

***(NB: This certificate of corrections/ revision should be submitted to the Dean School of Postgraduate Studies for clearance before the thesis can be hard bound)***

**NB:** The colour to be used for PhD hard-bound copies is Maroon while that for Masters is Black. Two copies of the hard-bound thesis together with a backup soft copy should be submitted to the Dean, School of Postgraduate Studies for distribution to the different stakeholders.

**PART I: CANDIDATE PARTICULARS**

Name of candidate Dr./Mr./Ms. ....

Registration No: .....

Department of study: .....

Cell phone No: .....

School: .....

Degree Title (MA, MED, PhD):.....

Area of specialization: .....

Title of Thesis: .....

.....

.....

.....

Date of Examination: .....

Signature of candidate: ..... Date: .....

**PART II: DECLARATION BY SUPERVISOR(S) OVERSEEING CORRECTIONS / REVISION**

I/We, the undersigned supervisor(s) overseeing corrections/revision of the thesis as advised by the candidate's Board of Examiners do hereby declare that all the corrections/revision have/has been effected as required.

Any other remarks

.....  
.....

**Names of Supervisors**

**Signature**

**Date**

|         |       |       |
|---------|-------|-------|
| 1. .... | ..... | ..... |
| 2. .... | ..... | ..... |
| 3. .... | ..... | ..... |

**PART III: CONFIRMATION BY THE CAMPUS POSTGRADUATE COORDINATOR**

I hereby do confirm that the supervisor(s) appointed to oversee the candidate doing the correction / revision on the project/thesis has/have done so as per the instructions of the candidate's Project Examiners/Board or Examiners

Name of Coordinator .....

Signature ..... Date .....

**PART IV: CONFIRMATION BY THE DEAN OF THE RELEVANT SCHOOL**

I hereby do confirm that the supervisor(s) appointed to oversee the candidate doing the correction / revision on the project/thesis has/have done so as per the instructions of the candidate's Project Examiners/Board or Examiners

Name of Dean .....

Signature ..... Date .....

Stamp.....

**PART V: COMMENTS BY THE DEAN SCHOOL OF, POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

Thesis should be hard-bound / not hard -bound (delete appropriately)

**NB:** Two copies of the hard-bound project/thesis together with a backup soft copy should be submitted to the Dean, School of Postgraduate Studies for distribution to the different stakeholders.

Name of the Dean.....

Signature: .....Date: .....

Stamp.....





**SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

***MKU/PG/F013: NOTICE OF INTENTION TO PRESENT RESEARCH  
PROPOSAL AT A SEMINAR***

***(To be filled in triplicate and received by the Dean, School of Postgraduate Studies  
fourteen (14) days before the date of seminar)***

**NB:** The Candidate to submit at least five (5) copies of the proposal to his/her Postgraduate Studies Coordinator at least seven (7) days before the date of the seminar to enable panelists to review the work well ahead of the presentation.

TO: Chairman, School of Postgraduate Studies Seminars Committee

**PART I PERSONAL DETAILS**

Name:.....  
Reg. No:.....  
Department:.....  
School .....,  
Address P. O. Box:.....  
E-mail:.....  
Cell phone No.....

Sir/Madam,

I intend to make a presentation of my PhD/Masters Research Proposal at the next postgraduate students' seminar scheduled for ..... day of .....20 .....

The title of my proposal is:

.....  
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.....

Area of specialization.....

Student's signature..... Date:.....

## PART II – SUPERVISORS’ CONSENT

I/We the undersigned have studied the research proposal of Mr/Ms.....who intends to present his/her Research proposal at the next Academic Seminar and I am/we are satisfied that the work falls within acceptable quality and standards for such presentation.

Name of 1<sup>st</sup> supervisor.....

Signature:..... Date:.....

Cell phone No: .....

Name of 2<sup>nd</sup> Supervisor: .....

Signature:..... Date:.....

Cell phone No:.....

MKU/PG/F014



**SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

***MKU/PG/F014: NOTICE OF INTENTION TO PRESENT AN ACADEMIC SEMINAR PAPER AT A FORUM***

***(To be filled in triplicate and received by the Dean, School of Postgraduate Studies fourteen (14) days before the date of seminar)***

**NB:** The Candidate to submit at least ten (10) copies of the proposed seminar paper to his/her Postgraduate Studies Coordinator at least thirty (30) days before the date of the proposed seminar to enable him/her to make arrangements for the seminar.

TO: Chairman, School of Postgraduate Studies Seminars Committee

**PART I: PERSONAL PARTICULARS**

Name of Student .....  
Reg. No. ....  
Department .....  
School .....  
Programme .....  
Address .....  
Email Address .....  
Cell Phone No.....

Sir/Madam,

I wish to make a presentation of an academic seminar paper to other postgraduate students at the next appropriate forum.

The title of my seminar paper is:

.....  
.....  
.....

Area of specialization.....

Student's signature.....Date:.....

## **PART II – SUPERVISORS’ CONSENT**

I/We the undersigned have studied the academic seminar paper by Dr./Mr./Mrs.....who intends to present it at an appropriate Academic forum and I am/we are satisfied that the seminar paper falls within acceptable levels of quality, formatting and standards for such presentation.

### **Name of 1<sup>st</sup> Supervisor**

Prof./Dr./Mr./Ms.....

Signature:..... Date:.....

Cell phone No:.....

### **Name of 2<sup>nd</sup> Supervisor**

Prof./Dr./Mr./Ms.....

Signature:..... Date:.....

Cell phone No:.....

## **PART III COMMENTS BY THE DEAN OF THE RELEVANT SCHOOL**

The school of ..... intends to hold a seminar on ..... day of ..... 20 ..... to accord opportunity for postgraduate students to present Academic Seminar papers on diverse fields of knowledge.

Name: Dean of School .....

Signature .....

Date .....

## **PART IV: COMMENTS BY DEAN, SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

The school of Postgraduate studies is in receipt of the information above and has no objection with the school holding the said seminar on the proposed dates.

Name of Dean .....  
(School of Postgraduate Studies)

Signature .....

Date:..... School Stamp .....

**PART III: CONFIRMATION BY THE CAMPUS SCHOOL POSTGRADUATE COORDINATOR**

I hereby do confirm that the supervisor(s) appointed to oversee the candidate's corrections /revision on the thesis has/have done so as per the instructions by the candidate's Board of Examiners.

Name of Coordinator .....

Signature ..... Date .....

Stamp .....

**PART IV: CONFIRMATION BY THE DEAN OF THE RELEVANT SCHOOL**

I hereby do confirm that the supervisor(s) appointed to oversee the candidate corrections/revision on the thesis has/have done so as per the instructions by the candidate's Board of Examiners.

Name of Dean .....

Signature ..... Date .....

Stamp.....

**PART V: COMMENTS BY THE DEAN SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

Thesis should be hard-bound/not hard-bound (delete appropriately).

Name of the Dean.....

Signature:.....Date: .....

Stamp.....

MKU/PG/F021



**SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

***MKU/PG/F021: PROJECT/THESIS ASSESSMENT GUIDE***

**Name of the Student:** .....**Reg. No.**.....

**School**.....**Department** .....

**Study title** .....

.....

.....

**Degree:** .....

| No | Criteria                                                                                                                               | Maximum Marks | Score |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------|
| 1. | <b>Preliminary Pages</b>                                                                                                               | 8             |       |
|    | • Clearly and concisely stated thesis title 2                                                                                          |               |       |
|    | • Abstract inclusive of the whole research report 2                                                                                    |               |       |
|    | • Consistency in the use of typeface and font size 2                                                                                   |               |       |
|    | • Table of content inclusive of all sections and subsections 2                                                                         |               |       |
| 2. | <b>Chapter One: Introduction</b>                                                                                                       | 3             |       |
|    | • Background to the study leads logically to the study                                                                                 |               |       |
|    | • The study problem is explicit and clearly stated                                                                                     | 3             |       |
|    | • Are objectives well stated – are they SMART 3                                                                                        | 8             |       |
|    | • Are the Research questions appropriate and clearly stated/Are the hypotheses clearly and logically testable? 2                       |               |       |
|    | • Is the Conceptual framework in line with the Objectives/Does the Theoretical framework addresses the variables to be investigated? 3 |               |       |
| 3. | <b>Chapter Two: Literature Review</b>                                                                                                  | 6             |       |
|    | • Literature reviewed relevant to research problem 4                                                                                   |               |       |
|    | • Recent sources of information used 2                                                                                                 |               |       |

|    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |    |  |
|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|--|
|    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Literature identifies the research gap to be addressed by the study 4</li> <li>All sources presented acknowledged 2</li> <li>In-text referencing correctly done 2</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 8  |  |
| 4. | <p><b>Chapter Three: Research Methodology</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Appropriateness of the Research design to Research Questions/hypotheses? 2</li> <li>Is the choice and justification of the study locale /site/area/acceptable? 1</li> <li>Adequacy of the description of Independent and Dependent variables/ Inclusion and exclusion criteria. 2</li> <li>Appropriateness of the description of Target population/ target organism and Sampling strategies. 2</li> <li>Piloting of research instruments for validity and reliability/quality control 1</li> <li>Have data collection techniques/experimental and laboratory techniques 2</li> <li>Ethical, Human Relations and Legal issues been adequately addressed? 2</li> <li>Is Data Analysis /data management plan appropriate? 2</li> </ul> | 14 |  |
| 5. | <p><b>Chapter Four: Research Findings and Discussion</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Is reporting of Results logical and consistent with design? 2</li> <li>Are all Research Questions/objectives adequately addressed? 2</li> <li>Data presentation: Tables, Graphs with proper numbering, titles, descriptions. 2</li> <li>Do figures and tables support the content in the text? 2</li> <li>Do the findings link directly to the reviewed literature? 2</li> <li>Was the data adequately analyzed and discussed? 2</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 12 |  |
| 6. | <p><b>Chapter Five: Summary, Conclusions and Recommendations</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Is the Research Summary appropriate? 1</li> <li>Is the conclusion consistent with the Findings and purpose of the study? 2</li> <li>Do conclusions relate to the study problem? 1</li> <li>Do the range of conclusions described relate to the Hypotheses or the Research Questions? 1</li> <li>Do recommendation emanate from the Findings and conclusions? 2</li> <li>Are the recommendations practical? 1</li> <li>Does the complete study generate new knowledge? 2</li> <li>Does the complete study reflect the researcher's competence in the subject? 2</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                        | 12 |  |





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**Name of the Examiner (Internal/External)**

**Prof/Dr./Mr./Mrs./Ms.....**

**Signature.....Date.....**

**SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

***MKU/PG/F023: RESEARCH THESIS ORAL EXAMINATION SCORING GUIDE***

**Name of the Student..... Reg. No.....**

.....

**Study title.....**

.....

| No | Criteria                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |               |                   |         |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------|---------|
|    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Maximum marks | Candidate's score | REMARKS |
| 1. | Ability and Level of Verbal presentation and Articulation                                                                                                                                                                                    | 2             |                   |         |
| 2. | Knowledge and understanding of subject matter.                                                                                                                                                                                               | 2             |                   |         |
| 3. | Evidence of broad review of recent related literature.                                                                                                                                                                                       | 2             |                   |         |
| 4. | Ability to establish linkages between Theoretical and Conceptual frameworks.                                                                                                                                                                 | 2             |                   |         |
| 5. | Suitability of research methodology and ability to articulate the research processes involved. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Sampling</li> <li>• Data collection</li> <li>• Data analysis</li> <li>• Data presentation</li> </ul> | 4             |                   |         |
| 6. | Ability to articulate new knowledge emerging from the study                                                                                                                                                                                  | 2             |                   |         |
| 7. | Adequacy and relevance of research findings in the field of knowledge                                                                                                                                                                        | 3             |                   |         |



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**Name of the Examiner/Panelist**

**Prof/Dr/Mr/Mrs/Ms.....**

**Designation**

.....

**Signature.....Date.....**

MKU/PG/F025



SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES

***MKU/PG/F025: APPLICATION FOR CHANGE OF THESIS TITLE***

***(NB: This Application for Change of Thesis title should be filled in triplicate)***

**PART I: CANDIDATE'S PARTICULARS**

Name of candidate Dr./Mr./Ms. ....

Registration No:.....

Department of study: .....

Cell phone No: .....

School: .....

Degree Title (MA, MED, Ph.D.)

.....  
.....

Area of specialization: .....

Present title:

.....  
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Proposed title: .....

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.....

I wish to change my project/thesis title to the proposed title as given above.

Signature..... Date.....

## **PART II: RECOMMENDATION BY THE SUPERVISOR(S)**

I/We, the undersigned supervisor(s) recommend that the new proposed title as given above be approved.

**Names of Supervisors**

**Signature**

**Date**

1. ....

2. ....

## **PART III: RECOMMENDATION BY THE HEAD OF RELEVANT DEPARTMENT**

I, approve the recommendation as above.

Name of the HoD.....

Signature: ..... Date: .....

Stamp.....

## **PART IV: RECOMMENDATION BY THE DEAN OF RELEVANT SCHOOL**

I approve the recommendation as above.

Name of the Dean .....

Signature: ..... Date: .....

Stamp.....

## **PART V: RECOMMENDATION BY THE DEAN SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES**

I approve the recommendation as above.

Name of the Dean .....

Signature: ..... Date: .....

Stamp.....



### SCHOOL OF POSTGRADUATE STUDIES

#### ***MKU/PG/F026: SUPERVISION FORM***

***(NB: This Supervision Form should be filled in triplicate and signed by both the student and the supervisor. A copy goes to SPGS (for PhD) through post.graduate@mku.ac.ke if you are emailing, it and to the relevant Department (for Masters) for filing, a copy for the supervisor and copy for the student.)***

|                                                     |  |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--|
| Name of Student                                     |  |
| Registration Number                                 |  |
| Name of Supervisor                                  |  |
| Date and Time                                       |  |
| Topics discussed                                    |  |
| Course of action for student                        |  |
| Do both parties consider the tutorial satisfactory? |  |
| Next meeting arranged for                           |  |
| Work submission date (if applicable)                |  |
| Comments                                            |  |
| Signature of Student                                |  |
| Signature of Supervisor                             |  |



### PhD Students' File Checklist

Name .....

Reg. No.....

Department.....

School.....

Programme.....

| Activity                                                                                                                         | Date | Comments |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|----------|
| Application form for admission                                                                                                   |      |          |
| Vetting of the application by the Postgraduate Committees of the relevant Schools, verdict and minutes of the committee meetings |      |          |
| Provisional Admission letter                                                                                                     |      |          |
| <b>For Thesis Only Students</b>                                                                                                  |      |          |
| Submission of a synopsis – A summary of the intended research area of study                                                      |      |          |
| Payment of fees                                                                                                                  |      |          |
| Substantive admission letter                                                                                                     |      |          |
| Result slips (Coursework)                                                                                                        |      |          |
| Proposed Supervisors from School                                                                                                 |      |          |
| CV of the supervisors and areas of specialization specified                                                                      |      |          |
| Approved Supervisors by the University Senate                                                                                    |      |          |
| Letters of appointment of supervisors                                                                                            |      |          |
| Monthly Supervision forms                                                                                                        |      |          |
| Progress reports every three months                                                                                              |      |          |



|                                                                                  |  |  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|
| Notice of Intention to submit Concept Paper for presentation at Department       |  |  |
| Minutes to SPGS                                                                  |  |  |
| Notice of Intention to submit the Proposal at the School level                   |  |  |
| Verdict of the defense and the minutes to SPGS                                   |  |  |
| Presentation of the Proposal at the School of Postgraduate level                 |  |  |
| Verdict and minutes of the defense                                               |  |  |
| Certificate of corrections Form No. 11                                           |  |  |
| Ethical Clearance certificate                                                    |  |  |
| Introduction letter from the SPGS for Data collection                            |  |  |
| Research in Progress seminar (1 <sup>st</sup> Seminar)                           |  |  |
| Research in Progress seminar (2 <sup>st</sup> Seminar)                           |  |  |
| Research Findings Dissemination seminar                                          |  |  |
| Notice of intention to submit thesis for examination                             |  |  |
| Proposed examiners and their CVs                                                 |  |  |
| Recommendation of the examiners by the SPGS Board                                |  |  |
| Approval of examiners by the University Senate                                   |  |  |
| Appointment of the examiners by the HRD                                          |  |  |
| Received reports and Score Sheets from the examiners                             |  |  |
| Invitation letters of the members of the Board of Examiners for Oral Examination |  |  |
| Invitation letter of the student for oral examination                            |  |  |
| Verdict copy and minutes (Report form)                                           |  |  |
| Copies of publications from thesis research work                                 |  |  |
| Memo forwarding the Thesis marks to School & Department                          |  |  |
| Certificate of corrections of the thesis for Hard binding. Form No. 12           |  |  |
| Memo from SPGS submitting the hard bound thesis to the relevant School           |  |  |

